Figure 2.2 Domain-data-related data mesh drivers

It's important to remember that these drivers, even in combination with organizational drivers presented in section 2.1.2, represent neither necessity nor sufficiency of a data mesh implementation. To make your consideration even more thorough, you should take into account other additional minor drivers. We explain them in the following section.

2.1.4 Minor organizational drivers

Minor organizational drivers are not critical for your journey (but could be considered when evaluating how costly your journey would be if you decide to start it). We believe that the data mesh is the next stage in architecture evolution. So, if your organization enjoys the benefits of well-developed maturity levels of governance, engineering, and domain-driven design, as well as data-savvy engineers, then the goal of your business case can be achieved relatively easily. The transition should also be relatively frictionless.

If these areas in your company are underdeveloped, but the major drivers described in sections 2.1.2 and 2.1.3 still push you toward a data mesh, then you need to consider the additional effort of required cultural change management. The following factors influence estimating costs and the effort needed to perform a transformation. Nevertheless, it should give you a solid starting point.

DATA GOVERNANCE MATURITY

One of the pillars of the data mesh is federated data governance, which we describe in detail in chapter 6. Irrespective of your current data governance model, the higher your data governance maturity level, the easier the transformation will be.

To evaluate your data governance maturity, we propose using the Gartner Data Governance Maturity Model, not to be confused with the Analytics Ascendency Model we referred to in section 2.12 (see http://mng.bz/XZl6). It divides governance maturity into six tiers: